Every Congress minister, except Kamal Nath and Jyotiraditya Scindia, seemed to be losing in the first round of counting.

But the big story was undoubtedly coming from UP. By 9.30 a.m., we had trends for almost fifty seats from the state. Except two (Sonia Gandhi in Rae Bareli and Mulayam Singh in Mainpuri), the BJP was ahead in all the rest. Shah was right, I said on air, this could really be a political tsunami.

At 9.32 a.m., I asked my producers to flash the big breaking news on the video wall—NDA set to win the 2014 elections; Narendra Modi poised to be India's next prime minister. News television works like a herd on major news days. Within minutes of us putting out the flash, every news channel in the country had followed.

A few hours later, the noise had settled a bit. Rahul Gandhi had recovered and was now leading in Amethi. He would eventually win by just over a lakh of votes, unlike 2009 when he had won by an impressive 3.70 lakh votes. Supriya Sule had edged ahead as well, as had Shashi Tharoor, but both their victory margins had been drastically reduced. There were no comebacks, though, for a majority of the Congress ministers. The only important BJP leader to bite the dust was Arun Jaitley in Amritsar, defeated because he had miscalculated the depth of anger against the Akalis.

There was little of interest left elsewhere. In Andhra Pradesh, the other key battleground, it was Chandrababu Naidu in Andhra and Chandrasekhar Rao in Telangana. 'You must come for the swearing-in,' Naidu's assistant SMS-ed me within minutes of the results being announced. KTR, son of Telangana's first chief minister, would send me a similar invite a few days later. I, as always, preferred to stay at home.

Meanwhile, there was another battle within a battle—Mamata Banerjee and Jayalalithaa were engaged in their own private duel about who would finish third. Eventually, Jaya would nose ahead, but neither Amma nor Didi were in any position to change the course of events in Delhi. The other potential prime ministerial pretenders had been almost wiped out. Mayawati, quite astonishingly, had drawn a blank. Mulayam Singh had won just five seats, all won by family members. Sharad Pawar's NCP was down